

drilling: there were 39 percent more employees in 2012 than there were in 2006. The mean salary is \$72,800, which explains why more young men and women are setting their sights on building. You'll need a good understanding of both sides of the business—how to please both the client who hires you and the contractors you hire—because as construction manager, it will be your job to see every project through from beginning to end.

4. **Registered nurse.** *Top 50 rank: #16.* RNs will be in greater demand as people continue to live longer and longer. And nurses' salaries are going up. The median annual salary for a registered nurse in 2012 was \$72,072, which is a 24 percent increase since 2006. Most provinces in Canada prefer an RN to have at least a bachelor's degree, but that isn't always the case. Quebec, for example, grants RN status to qualified college graduates. If you love helping people and want to actually make a life-or-death difference, this could be a great career for you.
5. **Dental hygienist.** *Top 50 rank: #18.* This sector has experienced a phenomenal 30 percent increase over the last six years. Hygienists today make a median salary of \$69,992, and there will be a projected 1.2 job openings per person in 2020. Here's the really good news: you must complete either a bachelor program *or* a dental hygiene diploma to be licensed and registered. The Commission on Dental Accreditation of Canada approves various programs, including many at colleges and private institutions. That means you can sidestep a pricey university degree and still make a killing by drilling.
6. **Metal-forming contractor and supervisor.** *Top 50 rank: #21.* Did you know there's a whole industry around metalworking? It shouldn't come as a surprise, considering